

Linux I/O Redirection



Understanding Standard Streams:

`stdin(0)` - Standard Input: Default is keyboard
`stderr(2)` - Standard Error: Default is terminal

`stdout(1)` - Standard Output: Default is terminal
`FD(n)` - File Descriptor: Reference to an I/O resource

Basic Redirections

<code>cmd < file</code>	Read input from a file instead of keyboard.
<code>cmd > file</code>	Send standard output to a file. Overwrites existing file.
<code>cmd >> file</code>	Append standard output to a file. Creates file if it doesn't exist.

Error Stream Redirections

<code>cmd 2> file</code>	Send error output to a file. Overwrites existing file.
<code>cmd 2>> file</code>	Append error output to a file. Creates file if it doesn't exist.
<code>cmd 2>&1</code>	Redirect stderr to the same destination as stdout.

Combined Redirections

<code>cmd > file 2>&1</code>	Send both stdout and stderr to the same file.
<code>cmd &> file</code>	Shorthand to redirect both stdout and stderr to the same file.
<code>cmd &>> file</code>	Append both stdout and stderr to the same file.
<code>cmd 2>&1 > file</code>	Redirect stderr to terminal, stdout to file. Order matters!

Here Documents and Here Strings

<code>cmd <<< "string"</code>	Send a single string to a command as input (here string).
<code>cmd << EOF</code> text EOF	Send multi-line text to a command as input (here document). Lines are read until the delimiter (e.g., EOF) is reached.

Pro Tips:

The order of redirections matters!
For example,

```
cmd > file 2>&1
```

sends both to file, while

```
cmd 2>&1 > file
```

sends `stderr` to terminal
and only stdout to file.

Use `|&` as shorthand for `2>&1 |`
to pipe both stdout and stderr.

